



Turning heads: Travis Head capped off Australia's ODI World Cup win last year with a sensational hundred in the final against host India. He is the frontrunner to open the batting for SRH this season. GETTY IMAGES

for the Capitals. With Mitchell Marsh, Harry Brook, and Yash Dhull, DC also possesses quality replacements for its first-choice opening pair.

KKR

Kolkata Knight Riders continues

to grapple with its opening conundrum. Having experimented with eight different pairs in the previous campaign — the most by any team — with none scoring over 100 together, it seeks stability. Rahmanullah Gurbaz and Jason Roy added 64 in four innings, while N. Jagadeesan and Roy combined for

83 in a solitary innings. Venkatesh Iyer could be paired up with Gurbaz at the top to accommodate Mitchell Starc, Andre Russell, and Sunil Narine.

Despite having only played one innings together, the right-left combination could be persisted with.

Successful opening pairs in IPL

	Pair	Innings	Runs	Average	100	50
1	S. Dhawan, D. A. Warner (Sunrisers Hyderabad)	48	2220	47.23	6	12
2	G. Gambhir, R. V. Uthappa (Kolkata Knight Riders)	39	1478	37.89	3	9
3	S. Dhawan, P. P. Shaw (Delhi Capitals)	44	1461	33.2	2	9
4	J. M. Bairstow, D. A. Warner (Sunrisers Hyderabad)	24	1401	58.37	5	7
5	M. A. Agarwal, K. L. Rahul (Kings XI Punjab, Punjab Kings)	24	1363	56.79	4	7
6	B. B. McCullum, D. R. Smith (Chennai Super Kings, Gujarat Lions)	38	1363	35.86	3	7
7	M. E. K. Hussey, M. Vijay (Chennai Super Kings)	34	1360	41.21	2	11
8	Q. de Kock, R. G. Sharma (Mumbai Indians)	37	1269	34.29	0	10
9	C. H. Gayle, V. Kohli (Royal Challengers Bangalore)	28	1210	46.53	4	4
10	D. P. Conway, R. D. Gaikwad (Chennai Super Kings)	22	1208	54.9	4	6